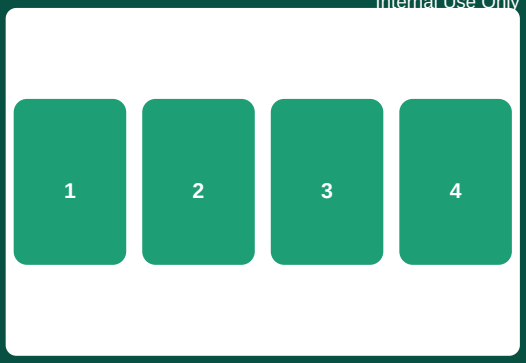
Internal Use Only

Stratification Diagram

Separate aggregate data into meaningful subgroups — by shift, machine, product, or operator — to reveal hidden



WHEN TO USE

When aggregate data masks the true source of a problem — 'the average looks okay but something is clearly wrong'.

HOW TO APPLY — STEPS

1. Define the problem metric to investigate
2. Identify potential stratification factors (shift, machine, operator, etc.)
3. Collect data tagged by each factor
4. Plot each stratum separately on a bar or line chart
5. Focus on the stratum with the worst performance and investigate

PRACTITIONER TIP

! The best stratification factor is the one that creates the biggest difference between groups — that's where to look.

KEY OUTPUTS

- Stratified comparison charts
- Performance table by stratum
- Root cause hypothesis for worst stratum

HOW TO MEASURE SUCCESS

Variance explained by the stratification factor; defect rate in worst-performing stratum

TOOL CATEGORY

Quality & Process